Peking. 10 July
Mr Wade
No 138.
Confidential
Recd Sept 21
Formosa. Japanese
policy – Chinese unprepared

For the Queen
Mr Disraeli
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Peking
10 July 1874

nfidential
No 139

My Lord,

In a despatch lately received from Yedo, Sir Harry Parkes informs me that he has been instructed by Your Lordship to take measures to prevent any breach of the Foreign Enlistment Act, and he is anxious to learn from me whether the Chinese Government has declared that the

The Right Honorable
The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

the proceedings of the Japanese amount to war.

I have written in reply that not only has the Chinese Government made no such declaration, but that it is, in my belief, little disposed to believe that the withdrawal of the Japanese from Formosa cannot in some way be negotiated. Preparations for war are of course being made, and with some activity; but the Chinese Government is in correspondence with the Government of Japan.

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A letter from the Tsungli Yamên delivered to Mr. Hart with a request that it should be transmitted to the Japanese Foreign Office direct, was entrusted by him to Mr. Mackean. Mr. Mackean did not go as a diplomatic Agent of the Chinese Government. He was proceeding to Japan on business connected with the scheme of Meteorological observations reported in my Despatch No. 178 of the 30th August 1873. He left Yedo with the reply on the 10th June, and returned

here

here a few days since. But except that explanations have been asked for on the one side and tendered on the other, nothing has transpired regarding the matter of this correspondence.

I have endeavoured in the numerous reports with which I have troubled Your Lordship on this subject to furnish the grounds for my own conviction that the Japanese, whether with or without the consent of the Central Government of Japan

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I cannot say, are determined to attempt the conquest of Formosa. Knowing the unpreparedness of the Chinese, their timidity, and abhorrence of action, the Japanese gain time by making the right of China to the ground they occupy a matter of discussion. The position of the Chinese on the other part is full of contradictions. They complain of acts of war but evade the admission of a rupture.

I have only to add for

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the present, that this attitude of the Chinese, in my opinion, best suits our interests. A declaration of War might not impossibly bring the Japanese down upon the open ports or upon districts which could not be disturbed without injury to our trade, and our obligation, as neutrals, to withdraw our subjects from the service of the Chinese, transferring as it too possibly might, the important part now played by them to

agents

agents of other nationalities, would be found, if I mistake not, seriously embarrassing.

I have the honor to be,

My Lord,

With the highest respect,

Your Lordship's most obedient

humble Servant

Thomas Francis Wade.

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1874
Peking 10 July
Mr. Wade
No. 139
Recd Sept 21

Japan. No declaration of War.

For the Queen
& Mr Disraeli
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Peking
10th July 1874

My Lord,

My Telegram of the 3rd inst will have informed Your Lordship of the conclusion of a Treaty between China and Peru.

In various despatches since the month of July 1873, I have reported, first, the apparent determination of the Chinese Government not to treat at all with Peru; then, its admission, at the instance

The Right Honble
The Earl of Derby